

72.2 COUNTABLE AND UNCOUNTABLE ABSTRACT NOUNS

Some abstract nouns have both countable and uncountable forms. The forms have a slight difference in meaning, with the countable form being specific and the uncountable form being more general.

COUNTABLE

I've been there a few **times**.

Each "time" is a specific occasion.



He has had many **successes**.

"Successes" are the specific achievements.



It has some great **qualities**.

"Qualities" refers to specific features.



We learned several new **skills**.

These are the particular abilities learned.



I've had some **thoughts** about it.

These are several specific thoughts.



This city has a great mix of **cultures**.

This refers to several different cultures.



There's a range of **abilities** in class.

"Abilities" refers to a variety of different skill levels.



UNCOUNTABLE

There's plenty of **time** left.

"Time" refers to the concept in general.

Hard work leads to **success**.

"Success" refers to achievement in general.

It has a reputation for **quality**.

"Quality" refers to a high standard.

It takes **skill** to do that job.

"Skill" is the general ability to do something.

The task requires **thought**.

"Thought" refers to the process of thinking.

The museum is filled with **culture**.

"Culture" refers to items of art and history.

She has great **ability** in writing.

"Ability" refers to general skill.